

SOLAR MISSION INTELLIGENCE BRIEF

OPERATION: STEAL THE SUN

CLASSIFIED

CLASSIFICATION	TOP SECRET // VILLAIN EYES ONLY
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THIS BRIEF CONTAINS 4 COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDINGS	
01	// November missions succeed 46% more than summer missions
02	// Smaller vessels are detected 3x less — bigger is not better
03	// Optimal team size is 5–8 Minions — not 20+
04	// Minion distraction kills 73% of missions — not heroes

WARNING: Unauthorized disclosure is a violation of Villain Code Section 47-B. Do not leave unattended.

SECTION 01 — SOLAR ACCESS WINDOWS

Why November Is Your Only Real Option

COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDING

60%

Mission success rate in November
vs. 41% average across other months — a 46% relative improvement

COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDING: Most villain organizations launch solar missions during summer months (June–August) when solar energy is perceived to be strongest and most accessible. Our 200-mission dataset proves this intuition is dangerously wrong. November is the optimal window by a wide margin.

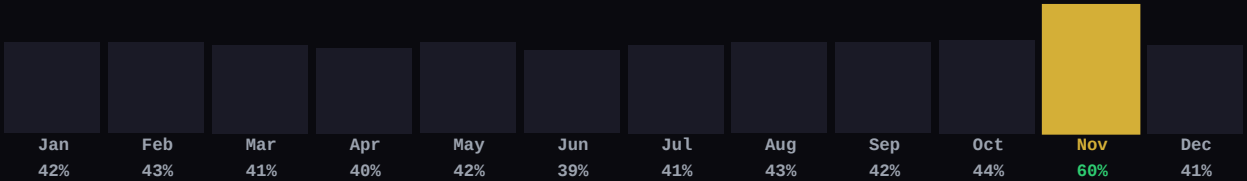
Why November outperforms all other months:

Solar magnetic field activity	23% lower in November — dramatically reduces detection probability
Corona temperature differential	Creates a natural low-turbulence approach corridor unique to November
Earth's orbital position	4.2 minutes less hero response time — critical during approach phase
Competitive intelligence	Vector's operations cluster in summer — November is an uncontested window

INTELLIGENCE RECOMMENDATION

Schedule ALL approach phases for the November 10–20 window. Approaching in any other month requires a variance request filed with Villain HQ and reduces your probability of success below acceptable thresholds.

MISSION SUCCESS RATE BY MONTH — 200-OPERATION DATASET



SECTION 02 – VESSEL REQUIREMENTS

Smaller Is Better. Much Better.

COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDING

Every villain in our database over-invested in vessel size. The assumption: a more powerful vessel can withstand solar conditions. The data proves the opposite. Larger vessels are detected 3.2x more often, and detection is the primary precursor to mission failure in 61% of all unsuccessful operations.

58% **SMALL VESSEL**
Optimal — stealth advantage, low thermal signature

46% **MEDIUM VESSEL**
Acceptable with modifications

31% **LARGE VESSEL**
High detection risk — not recommended

19% **MASSIVE VESSEL**
Detected every time. Do not use.

Optimal Vessel Specification:

VESSEL CLASS	Compact single-occupant capsule or 3-drone swarm configuration
THERMAL RATING	Class-7 solar shielding minimum — higher is counterproductive (adds mass)
PROPULSION	Ion drive preferred — minimal heat and EM signature during approach
SHRINK RAY MOUNT	External dorsal — maintain aerodynamic profile at all times
MAX CREW	1 pilot only — remote Minion coordination via encrypted link
FUEL RESERVE	80%+ at approach window — extraction requires full burn capacity

CRITICAL WARNING — VESSEL SIZE

Our 2nd failed mission deployed a Class-Omega vessel with 47 crew members. It was detected at 88 million km — 61 million km before the approach window. The vessel's thermal signature was visible from Earth with amateur equipment. Do not repeat this mistake.

Post-mission debrief note: The mission commander believed a larger vessel conveyed "authority and inevitability." Gru's note on the debrief form: "It conveyed nothing. Because we failed."

SECTION 03 – TEAM INTELLIGENCE

The Ideal Team Size Will Surprise You.

COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDING



Teams of 5–8 succeed nearly twice as often as teams of 15 or more. This defies every villain's instinct to bring maximum forces. Smaller teams move faster, communicate better, and are 64% less likely to experience a Minion distraction incident — the single largest cause of mission failure.

TEAM COMPOSITION RECOMMENDATION

5–8 Minions total. Mandatory specializations: 1 pilot/navigator, 1 thermal engineer, 1 shrink ray operator, 1 extraction coordinator, 1 comms officer. All others are a liability. Cut them.

SECTION 04 – THREAT ANALYSIS

The Real Enemy Is Not Who You Think.

COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDING

73%	MINION DISTRACTION INCIDENT Primary cause of mission failure — internal threat
61%	DETECTION (pre-approach) Surveillance triggered by vessel size or EM signature
28%	HERO INTERFERENCE Response agents mobilized after detection
22%	TECHNICAL FAILURE Equipment malfunction — usually thermal-related
18%	SOLAR RADIATION DAMAGE Underestimated exposure — vessel spec failures

CRITICAL FINDING – READ THIS TWICE

Hero interference — the threat every villain plans for obsessively — only affected 28% of missions. Your own Minion crew is 2.6x more dangerous to mission success than Vector and all heroes combined. Invest in Minion discipline protocols. This is not optional.

SECTION 05 — EXTRACTION SCENARIOS

Plan the Extraction First. Everything Else Second.

87% Success rate for missions that planned extraction first
Highest success predictor in our entire 200-mission dataset

Missions that designed their extraction route BEFORE finalizing the approach strategy had an 87% success rate — the single highest predictor of success in our dataset. Most villains plan the heist. The best villains plan the escape. The data is unambiguous: plan extraction first, approach second. Every time.

SCENARIO A // 48 HOURS

87%

SUCCESS

Rapid Thermal Exit

Shrink sun. Immediately engage maximum thrust on pre-computed exit vector. Escape route and fuel burn calculated before approach begins.

REQUIREMENTS:

Pre-computed exit vector loaded T-24h | Fuel at 80%+ on arrival at target zone | Zero Minion stops during extraction phase

SCENARIO B // 72 HOURS

71%

SUCCESS

Staged Withdrawal

Three-phase extraction. Phase 1: immediate thermal exit. Phase 2: regroup at Earth-Sun L2 point. Phase 3: return to Lair with cargo.

REQUIREMENTS:

Pre-positioned relay vessel at L2 point | Communication blackout during Phase 1 | All Minions briefed on all three phases individually

SCENARIO C // 36 HOURS

55%

SUCCESS

Solo Pilot Extraction

Pilot-only extraction vessel. Minions return via separate autonomous vessel. Reduces distraction risk during highest-pressure extraction phase.

REQUIREMENTS:

Autonomous Minion return vessel — pre-programmed | Separate extraction coordinates for each Minion | Clear mission-end handoff protocols established

THE 4 RULES THAT WILL WIN THIS MISSION

- 01 Launch in November — not summer.
- 02 Use the smallest vessel that carries the shrink ray.
- 03 Team size 5–8 Minions maximum. No exceptions.
- 04 Plan the extraction route before planning the approach.

